



SESSION 4: COACH

Conflict and recovery

Having difficult conversations

COACH OBJECTIVE

You teach players how to handle conflicts constructively. Conflict avoidance weakens a team. Good conflict management makes a team stronger. Players practice direct, respectful communication.

COACH NOTE

Your role during conflicts: don't solve it immediately, guide it instead. Give space to both sides. Use the I-message technique: I feel X when you do Y, I ask you to do Z. Practice this yourself too. Pitfall: don't pick a side before you've heard both versions.

ACTIVITIES**1 Recognizing conflict styles**

⌚ 10 min

Discuss four conflict styles: avoiding, attacking, giving in, collaborating. Ask: which do you recognize in yourself? Which is most effective for the team? Answer: collaborating.

2 Roleplay: difficult conversation

⌚ 15 min

Pairs act out a scenario: player A is upset with player B for always being late. Use the I-message structure. After three minutes: switch roles and discuss what worked.

3 Setting up a recovery protocol

⌚ 5 min

Together set up a short recovery protocol. What do you do after a conflict? One: cool down, 24 hours. Two: direct conversation, no third parties. Three: coach as mediator if needed. Four: restore the agreement.

NOTES



DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- How do you currently resolve conflicts within the team?
- What is the difference between a conflict that weakens the team and one that makes it stronger?
- When do you involve the coach and when do you solve it yourself?

CLOSING

Hang the recovery protocol next to the team contract. Explain: conflicts are normal, what matters is how you deal with them. Teams that process conflicts well are the strongest teams.

NOTES

"Peace is not the absence of conflict. It is the ability to handle conflict by peaceful means."

Ronald Reagan